STREAMLINING IP PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION PHASE

Introduction

This phase focuses on preparing the complete documentation of the project **"Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer."**

The documentation describes the project problem, objectives, development process, testing, workflow, benefits, and final outcome.

Problem Statement

The existing IT procurement process for standard laptop orders involves manual work, which can cause delays, configuration oversights, and inefficient resource allocation.

This project addresses these issues by automating the standard laptop ordering process using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

User Story

The IT procurement team requires a streamlined process for standard laptop ordering. When a standard laptop is requested, the required task should be automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration.

Project Objectives

The main objectives of the project are:

- Automate standard laptop ordering using Flow Designer.
- Reduce manual intervention.
- Reduce errors and waiting time.
- Automatically create the required catalog task.
- Assign the task to the Hardware team.
- Improve resource utilization and task allocation.
- Improve overall procurement efficiency.

Technologies Used

Platform: ServiceNow

Feature: Flow Designer

Application: Service Catalog

Automation: Create Catalog Task

Assignment Group: Hardware

Project Development

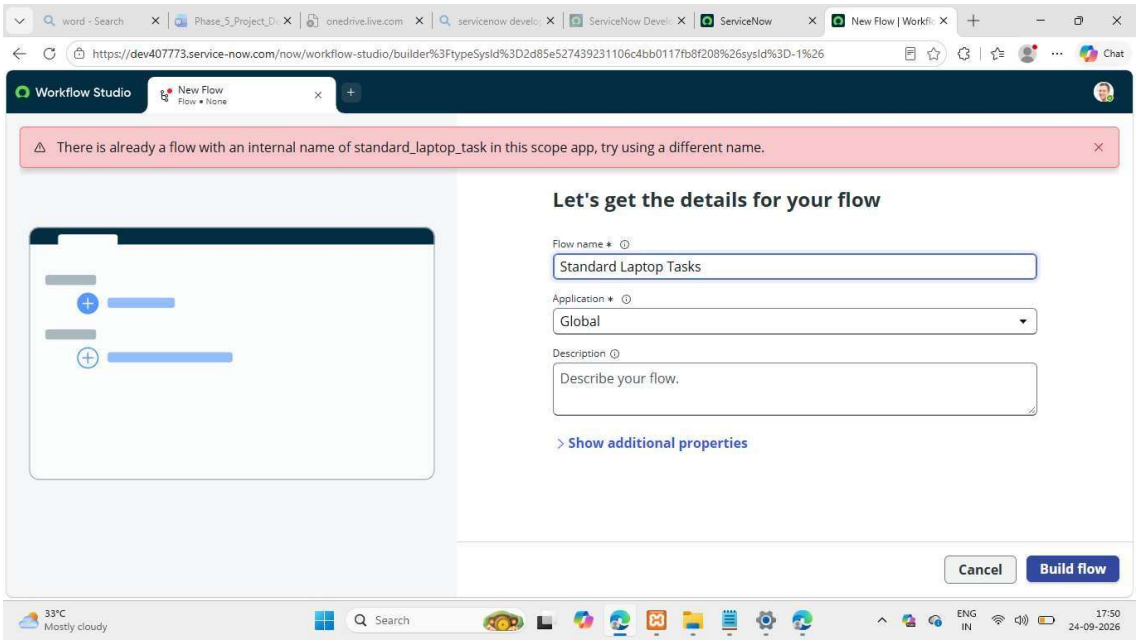
The project was developed by creating a Flow Designer workflow for the Standard Laptop catalog item.

The flow contains a **Service Catalog trigger** and a **Create Catalog Task** action. The catalog task is configured with the required request item, short description, description, Hardware assignment group, and approval details.

Flow Creation

A flow named **Standard laptop task** was created in Flow Designer.

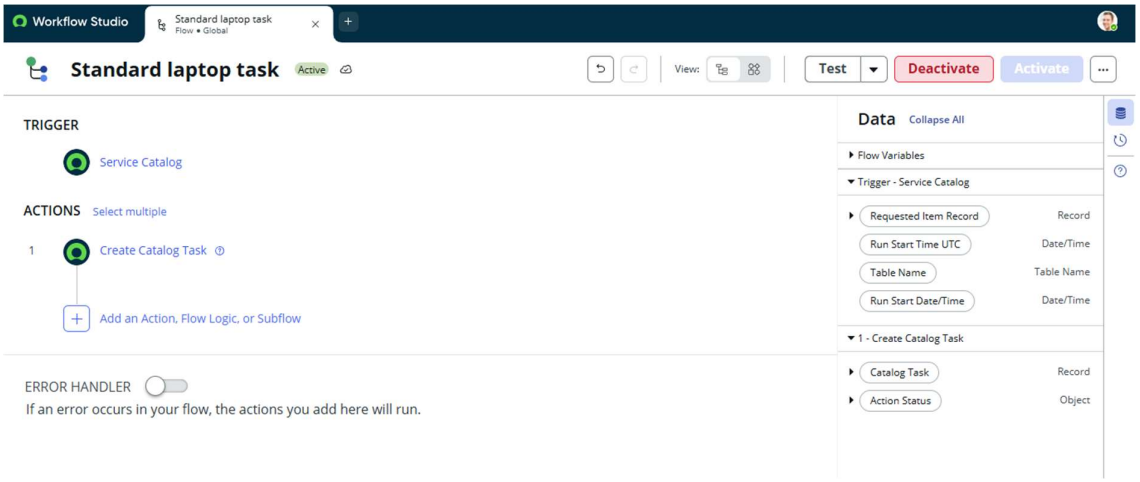
Screenshot – Flow Creation



Flow Configuration

The Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Task action were configured according to the project requirements.

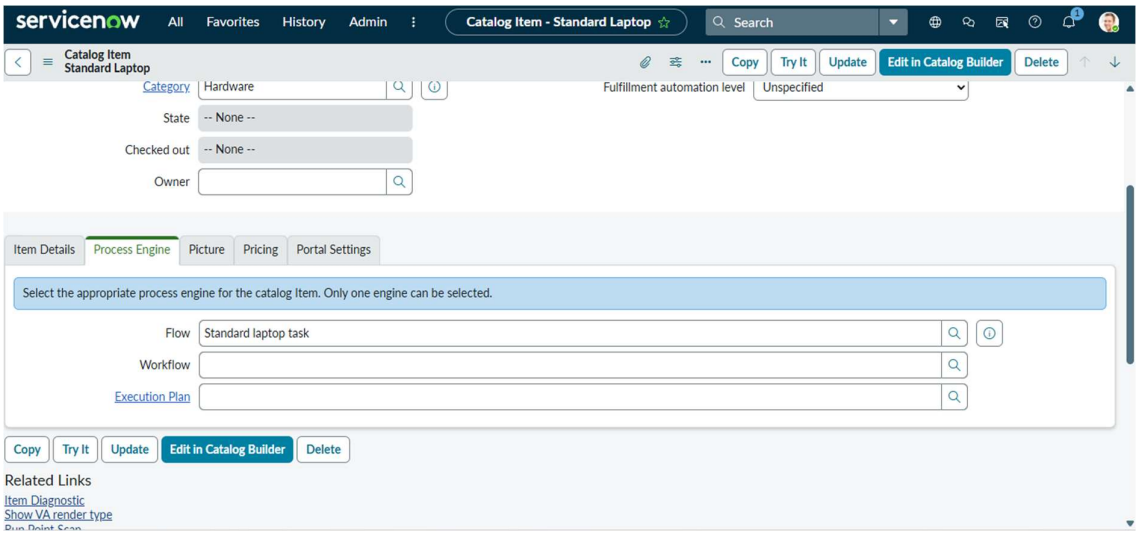
Screenshot – Flow Configuration



Flow Assignment

The created flow was assigned to the **Standard Laptop** catalog item through the Process Engine configuration.

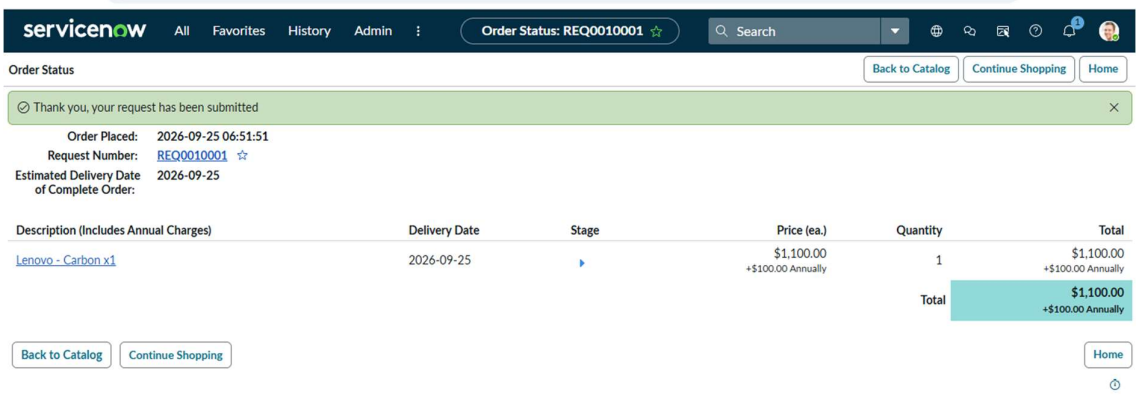
Screenshot – Flow Assignment



Service Catalog Process

The Standard Laptop item was opened through the Service Catalog and an order was placed using **Order Now**.

Screenshot – Standard Laptop Order

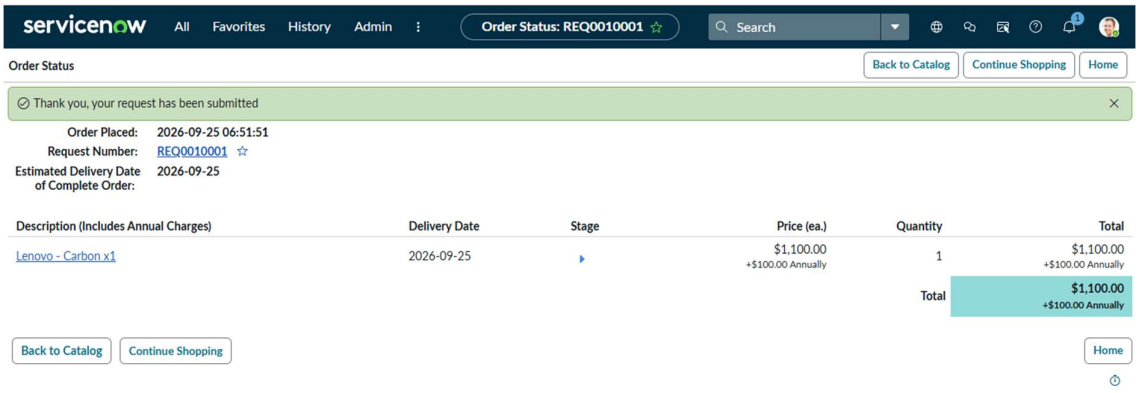


Approval Process

After placing the order, the generated request was opened and the Approvers section was checked.

The request was then approved to continue the process.

Screenshot – Request Approval

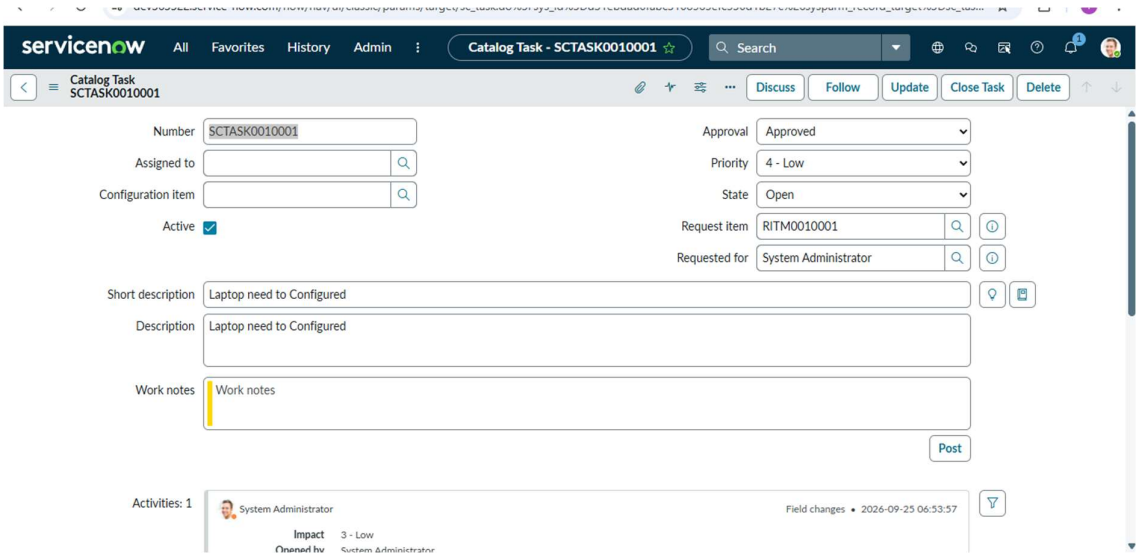


Catalog Task Generation

After approval, the Requested Item was opened and the Catalog Tasks section was checked.

The generated catalog task was opened to verify its status, short description, and assigned group.

Screenshot – Generated Catalog Task



Testing Summary

The implemented workflow was tested by placing a Standard Laptop order and checking whether the configured automation generated the required Catalog Task.

The following were verified:

- Standard Laptop request creation.
- Request approval.
- Flow execution.
- Catalog Task generation.
- Short Description.
- Task status.
- Hardware group assignment.

Project Benefits

The implemented automation helps:

- Reduce manual intervention.
- Reduce waiting time.
- Improve task allocation.
- Improve resource utilization.
- Reduce errors in the procurement process.
- Provide a smoother laptop ordering process.
- Improve overall productivity.

Complete Workflow

Standard Laptop→ Order Now → Request Created → Approval → Requested Item → Catalog Task Automatically Created → Hardware Group Assignment

Project Outcome

The project successfully demonstrates an automated workflow for standard laptop procurement. The Standard Laptop request can be processed through ServiceNow Flow Designer, and the required Catalog Task is generated and assigned to the Hardware team.

Conclusion

The **Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer** project demonstrates how ServiceNow Flow Designer can automate a standard laptop procurement process.

The documentation presents the complete project implementation, testing process, workflow, and final outcome. The automation reduces manual effort and helps improve the efficiency of IT procurement.